

When were locomotives invented?

The first steam-powered train engine was invented in 1804 by an English engineer named Richard Trevithick. It worked by burning coal to boil water into steam, which moved the train. In 1829, George Stephenson built the Rocket—a better, faster version of the steam locomotive.

Water supply

Water was stored in a barrel. When the engineer needed it, he made it flow through pipes to the boiler where it was turned to steam.

Engine supplies

A cart at the back of the train carried the coal and water the engine needed to make it go.

The Rocket's top speed was **29 mph** (46 kph). Today's fastest train reaches **300 mph** (480 kph)!

The first public steam railroad opened in 1825.

